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I think what in this post resonated with me now after being in introductory piano class this semester is how the progress that I wanted in my head was nothing to where I got to but it's still something I am proud of. In the blog post, he mentioned that there is a kind of ideal that you are going to be that person at the fireplace at the piano playing as everyone sings along, that's something I am nowhere close to. And maybe just a bit of me did have that goal, especially with the fact that whenever I told everyone I was learning the piano I felt like that's what they expected from me. Something where I would be this great prodigy of a piano player after this class. But I am not and it's ok with me. Being able to see back and play back my assignments recording to see where I have gotten from is an astonishing surprise no matter what the progress is. I am proud of that and I feel that's what resonated with me when I reread through this article now with the knowledge I have.

I think one lesson that resonated with me this semester is the one about being vulnerable as you are learning (lesson 1). I have always felt the need to excel at what I do right from the get-go so this being an intro class and something I have never done before was a change at first. Playing scales for so long and trying to get better and better at it was hard at first. A lot of the time I would be in the practice rooms just attempting to play those scales. At some points, it would become miserable because I would think about how my math, science, and history classes were so much more advanced but here I was still struggling with something as simple as coming down to connecting my brain to the motor functions in my fingers. At those times I had to take a step back and be okay with just trying it again and continuing to hack at it until I got it. Or sometimes even if I didn't get it, I just walk away from it and take a break and be okay with where I have gotten to and that I can pick it up in a bit when I realize that I can be a beginner, and that's okay. Nothing in my self-value changed by starting something that may have been considered to be started at a younger age.

Another lesson that resonated with me was the one about I do have time (lesson 6). This was something that I found out that I did have when I had to put it into my schedule. I blocked off specific days where I could get my practice done in the week down as a routine and kept that routine. It made it so much easier to have a specific time to work on the practice assignment and other things without feeling overwhelmed or trying to put it on the back burner. It just amazed me how much in the semester I could keep continuing to practice even when things got busy because I had already put that time away. And that also made me see how I could do that with anything and everything as long as I put my mind to it. All those extra distractions like social media were just something I wasted my time on (still do in some aspects but getting better at). And when I instead used my time practicing it became therapeutic as the author said in the article. It became nice to do and accomplish certain tasks in my block of practice time no matter how small or big those tasks had been.

One lesson that I think I would have added to the author's list of lessons would be the lesson that your mind is only just that a mind and you have the power to control it. So many times as I was doing my last assignment of the composition which, was the biggest and hardest task of this assignment, I kept thinking that I just didn't have the mind or talent to make something. To create a piece but in reality I did. I just had to conquer that thinking and be like yeah it might not be the best most renowned thing but it was still something. Even if it follows a typical pattern and is something super ordinary it's not bad and that outcome didn't mean that I didn't have that creative side. Most time in class we had been just kind of copying things, so that really big creative aspect of this last assignment was daunting to go for but I am really happy with what I have gotten with my time constraints and abilities. It is not something I hate and all that it took me to get there was to control my mind and realize that everything I make isn't that bad. I didn't have to redo it every time. And that also everything I added on I was putting in a new element that would help it in the long run. All it was at the end of the day was a game of taking power from your wandering mind.